

WET HOT AMERICAN SUMMER

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Table Read Revisions by Jeff

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Second Draft

Movie accurate, not cast yet

"Jane" by Jefferson Starship begins with opening TITLES over black"

CUT TO:

EXT. CAMPFIRE SITE - NIGHT

Music KICKS IN.

A large group of summer camp counselors hanging out by a campfire, their faces lit only by the flames. The counselors dance and play guitar to the music, snuggle under blanket make marshmallow s'mores, feel each other up, play fight, make out.

TITLE: AUGUST 18, 1981

MUSIC / TITLES CONTINUE

EXT. VARIOUS - DAWN

The sun rises on a serene lake in rural New England to reveal Camp Firewood: A dozen wooden cabins, basketball court, ball field, rec hall, flagpole and mess hall. The last image is of a GROUNDSKEEPER who peels and eats a banana, the sound of which dissolves with...

INT. KATIE'S BUNK - DAWN

The banana-like sound of ravenous adolescent MAKING OUT emanates from each bunk bed in the cabin.

At one point, a 14 year old BUNK BOY emerges from under one of the blankets, squinting from the light coming in.

BUNK BOY
(in a loud whisper)
You guys!

From under each blanket, a boy's tousled head emerges.

BUNK BOY (cont'd)
We gotta get back!

EIGHT BOYS now come out from under the blankets, separating from the EIGHT GIRLS they've been making out with. The boys are fully dressed in dark sweatsuits.

They flip up their goods and DASH out of the bunk.

EXT. KATIE'S BUNK - DAWN

Music and credits continue.

They exchange rushed "hello's" as they pass a group of GIRLS, also in sweatsuits, trekking back to their bunks in the opposite direction.

The boys break onto the main field. Dawn. Hundreds of sweat suited campers scurry about.

Everyone -- campers, counselors and staff -- are awake, desperately trying to make it back before the day begins.

EXT. BETH'S OFFICE/EXT. PROFESSOR'S COTTAGE - DAWN

BETH, the camp director, wearing her pajamas, sits on the stoop of the camp office, sipping coffee with the NURSE. Boys and girls clumsily sneak by.

BETH
(halfheartedly to the kids)
You guys aren't supposed to be out
of your bunks. You're in
trouble...

INT. COOP'S BUNK - DAWN

COOP, a 17 year old counselor, sleeps in his cot. He is surrounded by BOBBY, TIMOTHY and several 10-year-old boys in their underwear.

CAMPERS
(singing softly)
*"Standing in the rain, with his
head hung low"*

COOP
(eyes opening)
Guys, please don't sing. I'm up.
I'm up.

CAMPERS
(a little louder)
*"Couldn't get a ticket, it was a
sold out show. Heard the roar of
the crowd he could picture the
scene. Put his ear to the wall
then like a distant scream. He
heard one guitar just blew him
away"*

The campers SCREAM, jump on top of Coop, banging their feet and air-guitaring with badminton rackets and whiffle-ball bats.

COOP
Okay, okay!

The boys run off, giggling.

Coop puts on a ratty sweatsuit and splashes some Polo cologne on his chin.

INT. KATIE'S BUNK - DAWN

The eight girls, now awake in their ratty sweatsuits, are crowded around a small mirror, putting on makeup.

Their counselor, KATIE, 16, is standing by the door.

KATIE
Let's go girls, you look hot. The
Bunk 5 boys are going to freak out
when they see you at kick ball.
Let's go!

EXT. BETH'S OFFICE/EXT. PROFESSOR'S COTTAGE

In the distance, Beth sees PROFESSOR NEUMANN, 40's working in the garden outside of his cottage across the lake. They awkwardly smile at each other.

EXT. COOP'S BUNK - DAWN

As Coop leaves his bunk, we hear the voice-over of ARTY, the DJ of the camp radio station. Under this voice-over, we follow Coop as he heads out to the field, among everyone else.

ARTY (V.O.)
Good morning everybody, well, it's
the last day of camp. It'll be sad
to shut down WCFW for the summer.
But not to worry, because those of
you in the Bethesda, Chevy Chase
area can hear me all winter long
on Jewish Day School Radio 89.9 FM
- The Fox! For those select few of
you who went all summer, all eight
weeks, without finding that
special someone, today's your day.
You don't want to go back home and
lie to your friends about a summer
romance that didn't happen. You
don't want to be the one person
who doesn't have any one to kiss
tonight after the talent show.

ARTY (V.O.)
So seize the day, Camp Firewood.
It's your last!

EXT. FLAGPOLE (NEXT TO DINING HALL) - DAWN

PAUL, 17, a counselor with an ever present guitar, stands near the flagpole overlooking the main field.

Next to Paul is MOOSE, 10, an overweight crew-cutted spectacle of a boy. The two work on putting up the flag.

The whole camp is assembled in front of the flag pole. Everybody is straining to stay awake. Moose silently raises the flag up the pole.

Coop stands with his campers keeping them in line.

KATIE and ANDY, the hot camp couple, straggle up to the flagpole arm in arm, French kiss grossly and part ways.

Katie, after-glowing, stands with her campers next to Coop. Coop steals a glance at her. She smiles at him. He turns away, pretending like he was looking everywhere.

Coop, now extremely self-conscious, shifts awkwardly trying to look cool.

KATIE
(joking seductively)
Coop, do you like watching me and
Andy make-out?

COOP
No! What do you mean? That's a
stupid thing to say...

Katie makes sexy faces at Coop. He is totally embarrassed.

KATIE
Oh God, Coop...you look so sexy in
that sweatshirt.

COOP
Uh huh.

KATIE
Oooh, your ass is so hot.

COOP
Stop it.

KATIE
Do you wanna sit on my face?

COOP
 Okay! I get it. It's very funny.
 Now stop.

KATIE
 (hugging him)
 OH come on, Coop, you know I'm
 just kidding.

COOP
 I know and it's very very funny.

KATIE
 Okay, I'm sorry. I'll make it up
 to you.

COOP
 That's okay. You've done enough.

KATIE
 I'm gonna find you a woman today-

COOP
 Honestly, don't worry about it-

COOP
 Well I guess I'll cancel that
 order of onions and limburger
 cheese I made for lunch. Ha!

KATIE
 Yeah...

Katie starts to walk away

COOP
 I want you inside me.

KATIE
 What?

COOP
 Hm? Hey, what's up?

Katie walks into the dining hall with all the kids. VICTOR, 17,
 the adventure counselor, approaches.

VICTOR
 Coop, were you just talking to
 Katie? What was that?

COOP

I don't know, but it was bar none,
the longest conversation I've ever
had with her in six years at camp.

VICTOR

So does she want to fuck me? Is
that was she was asking you about?
Because tell her that I will. In
fact don't tell her that - tell
her I might.

COOP

Victor, I don't know quite how to
say this but your name didn't come
up.

VICTOR

I know she wants to fuck me. Why
else would she talk to you. No
offense.

COOP

None taken.

EXT. PROFESSOR'S COTTAGE - MORNING

Beth approaches PROFESSOR NEUMANN as he tends to his garden.

BETH

Hi there, I'm Beth.

PROFESSOR

Ah, very nice to meet you. I'm
Henry.

BETH

I've seen you here all summer and
I thought I'd, you know,
"Introduce Myself".

She hold out her hand to shake. Unaware of what she's doing
Professor hands her a gardening trowel. Making the most of the
situation, Beth playfully waves the trowel in the air. The top
part of it flies off, leaving her with just the handle. They
giggle awkwardly.

BETH

So...

PROFESSOR

So...

Henry leans on a flower pot. His fist sinks into the dirt. He pretends it didn't happen and leaves his hand in the pot.

PROFESSOR (cont'd)
(trying to act normal)
So you work over at the camp, huh?

BETH
Yes, I'm the director. How about you?

Beth gives Professor a flirtatious smile and sits down on the grass. The Professor doesn't sit.

PROFESSOR
Me? Nah - I don't work over there.

Beth pops back up as if she never sat down.

BETH
No? I mean, I know you don't work at the camp, silly. I'm the director.

PROFESSOR
Right. (pause) Right! I teach Astrophysics over at the college during the school year, and I. Are her this summer to relax and reflect.

BETH
So you're a professor, huh?

PROFESSOR
Yeah, well, actually Associate Professor.

BETH
Well what do you teach?

Professor nonchalantly runs his mulch hand through his hair.

PROFESSOR
Well, like I said before, Astrophysics. I study pace, the stars, comets, you know, things like that.

BETH
Oooh - space! The "final frontier" - right?

PROFESSOR
Right. Thanks for everything.

BETH

Hey - would you be willing to come
teach some of the campers about
space?

PROFESSOR

(sheepish)

Oh no, I couldn't possibly...

BETH

Oh please, they'd love to hear
about the-

PROFESSOR

I SAID NO!!! I'm sorry.

Beth is embarrassed.

INT. MESS HALL - SERVING AREA - MORNING

Among the noisy cacophony of a hundred hungry kids, Victor, Coop and others line up with their trays waiting to be served breakfast. ABBY, a cute counselor, looks over at them, smiling.

VICTOR

Look at Abby. She wants to fuck me
Coop, so help me god, she wants to
fuck me.

COOP

And this time, Victor, I'm sure
it's true.

VICTOR

I have to admit, Abby Bernstein is
one of the only berry bushes I
have yet to pollinate. If you
catch my meaning?

COOP

You mean you've fucked every girl
here except for Abby.

VICTOR

That is exactly what I mean.

Victor now addresses GENE, the main chef, a gigantic and menacing Vietnam vet.

VICTOR (cont'd)

Hey, Gene, are there any more
potatoes?

GENE
GARY! BRING OUT THE TATERS!

GARY, the counselor who works in the kitchen, comes out with a tray of potatoes.

GARY
Here they are.

COOP
Gary!

VICTOR
What's up dude.

GARY
Hey guys.

GENE
What's that, Shithead?

GARY
I said, "hey guys". What's your glitch, Gene?

GENE
You listen to me, you fucked up little cigarette smoking piece of shit! I was in the Vietnam war!

GARY
I know...

GENE
That was a little over ten years ago.

Victor catches Abby's eye. She seductively licks her plastic cereal spoon. Victor doesn't know how to respond.

INT. MESS HALL - MORNING

Nearby, a 13 year old boy in an "I Hate Mondays" t-shirt and a black cape gets out of his chair and goes over to a table of girls. He addresses them, rolling a multi-sided die in his hand.

CAPED BOY
Excuse me ladies. You may remember me as the guy who came to dinner a few weeks ago with underwear on my head. My name is Keith Stack.

CAPED BOY

I'm from Millburn, New Jersey,
state bird, the mosquito. This
completes my ninth full summer at
Firewood. And as you may have
heard, I'm a recently crowned
class B Dungeon Master, so if
anyones wants to play D&D today,
please speak now or forever hold
your peace. Anyone?

He gets no response. He looks to a cute young girl, ALEXA.

CAPED BOY

Alexa, maybe you'd like to join
in? We do need a druid. You've
definitely cast a level five charm
spell on me.

ALEXA

In your dreams, douchebag.

CAPED BOY

Douchebags are hygienic products.
I take that as a compliment. Thank
you.

Caped Boy goes back to his table, beaming with pride.

ALEXA

Eeww. Ewww. Eewww!

INT. MESS HALL - MORNING

Beth sits at another table, chatting with older staff and
visitors, including the NURSE and GAIL, the Arts and Crafts
instructor, both 30's.

BETH

We've made it to the end of the
summer, and everyone's still in
one piece -- except for a couple
of kids, who are lepers...

NURSE

Good one, Beth.

Gene brings in a tin platter covered in overlapping fried eggs
and drops it in on the table wit ha thud, and turns back toward
the kitchen.

BETH
Thank you Gene!

Without turning back around to face her, Gene gives Beth the finger.

Beth looks up to see Professor Neumann shyly coming into the mess hall. He looks around, and finally approaches Jenny "JJ" Janakowski, 17, a rowdy counselor.

PROFESSOR
Where would I find the -- how
should I put this -- the sci-fi,
nerdy...

JJ's not sure exactly what he means.

PROFESSOR
...the "indoor" kids.

Without hesitation, he points to Caped Boy's table.

JJ
Bunk 3.

Professor goes over there.

PROFESSOR
Hey guys. I'm associate Professor
Neumann. Anyone want to spend the
last day of camp doing science
projects?

Five campers hands shoot into the air: CAPED BOY, MORK BOY.
CURE GIRL, and MALLRAT GIRL

Beth and Professor catch each other's eyes across the room.
They smile.

INT. MESS HALL (KITCHEN) - MORNING

At the serving area, Gene and Gary:

GENE
I seen more fucked up shit happen
in five minutes out there than
you'll see in your whole fuckin'
life!

GARY
Yeah well Gene - I'm really sorry.
If I could change history, I
would.

GENE

Fuck you! Now we need to make eight gallons of bug juice by snack hour! Do you know where the powder packets are?

GARY

Yeah --

GENE

-- In the pantry over the sink! Right next to my bottle of dick cream. Wait! Ignore that last comment.

GARY

Did you say "dick cream"?

GENE

No! I said, uh, stick team! You know, stick team? Stick ball! Forget about it. Go away. Leave me alone.

GARY

I'm pretty sure you said "dick cream" but...

INT. MESS HALL - MORNING

Back at Beth's table, she leans her chair back to where Victor is sitting.

BETH

Victor - I need you and Neil to take the Eagles out on Moose River today. I made them a promise.

VICTOR

This is my last day of camp, Beth. That's not gonna work for me.

BETH

Oh! That's not gonna work for you! How about this as a compromise: The kids are gonna go out on the Moose River. And you and Neil are gonna take them.

VICTOR

What?!?

INT. MESS HALL - MORNING - ANOTHER TABLE

SUSIE, the drama counselor, is going from table to table with BEN, the best looking counselor in camp.

SUSIE

Hey you guys, focus up, all eyes here. I just want to let everyone know that Ben and I are producing a musical number from "Godspell" for the talent show tonight. Well he's producing, I'm directing-slash-choreographing.

BEN

And I'm only saying this from past experience, but if you can't carry a tune, please don't come into an audition environment and waste our time. For serious, okay?

SUSIE

Also, bring movement clothes with you a.k.a. Jazz shoes, dance belts Lycras, et al. And FYI, this project isn't an excuse to get out of your other activities. It's an excuse to do good musical theater. So be prepared, be enthusiastic and leave your bullshit attitudes and baggage at the door, cause we don't need it!

(beat, switching to another table)

Hey guys! Everyone focus up!

EXT. MESS HALL - MORNING

Just outside the mess hall, Katie is kissing ANDY, 17, a greasy gorgeous and rebellious looking counselor.

KATIE

...So, I was thinking maybe we could take a walk later, maybe go out by Gunner's Pass, one last time.

ANDY

(pushing her away)

Ugghhhh! Katie, you're suffocating me! I'm choking here! I need breathing room!

KATIE

I just want to spend time with you. It's the last day of camp.

ANDY

My butt itches.

KATIE

What are you talking about? We're soulmates, right?

ANDY

Uhh - yeah, if you want...

Andy leans into the cafeteria door and yells in.

ANDY (CONT'D)

Hey JJ - save me a waffle!

He goes back to Katie.

KATIE

Andy come on! This is serious! I want this day to be special.

ANDY

Fuck you, dyke!

KATIE

Why are you being such an asshole?

ANDY

I'm gonna go finish my breakfast. I love you baby. It's so good talking to you.

Andy kisses her and nonchalantly reenters the mess hall, high fives someone, sits down at his table and resumes eating.

KATIE

See you in macrame!

Andy gives her the finger behind his back.

EXT. MESS HALL / PARKING LOT - DAY

Everyone leaves the mess hall.

ARTY (V.O.)

One last successful B.K.F.S.T. becomes one for the record books.

ARTY (V.O.)
And with T minus eleven hours to
the big talent show, we sail on,
aboard the good ship Firewood,
toward a little oasis that I like
to call morning activity time...

JJ, Gary, McKinley and others, straggle to the hill.

In the distance, they see Beth escorting a sad distraught 12-
year-old camper, SILAS into a car with his angry parents.

JJ
What's going on with Silas?

GARY
You didn't hear? He got kicked out
of camp?

JJ
Why?

GARY
He snuck into the office last
night and videotaped himself
jerk off.

JJ
You're kidding.

MCKINLEY
Where's the tape?

GARY
He has it.

MCKINLEY
We've got to find it.

JJ
It's a subject matter I'm sure
you're familiar with, McKinley!

MCKINLEY
Shut up!

JJ
No you shut up!

The counselors wrestle each other to the ground.

INT. ARTS AND CRAFTS BUNK - DAY

Gail is teaching a group of 9-year-old campers in the cluttered arts and crafts shack. She is rummaging through a storage cubby looking for materials.

GAIL

Okay, kids, We're gonna use the crayons to make some decorations for the talent show.

VALERIE

Is that your wedding ring, Gail?

Gail shudders as if that was the worst question in the world.

GAIL

No. I mean yes. It was. It used to be. I mean legally...it's so twisted...his lawyer won't even call me now, and...Oh God...

Another camper screams from his table.

BOY CAMPER

Where's the crayons?

GAIL

The crayons...uh...is right here - in my hand.

She pulls a brown crayon from the box.

One camper, Valerie, brings out several large cases of colored markers.

VALERIE

We could draw with the markers.

Gail leans in close to Valerie and speaks in a low tone.

GAIL

Listen, Valerie, I need you to be helpful here. Okay. I do not need you to undermine me.

VALERIE

But there's only one crayon left and it's brown. There're literally hundreds of colored markers.

Gail BURSTS INTO TEARS.

EXT. PARKING LOT (WATERFRONT) - DAY

Victor loads a raft on top of a fifteen passenger van, while his co-counselor NEIL waits inside with a group of young campers. Abby approaches Victor.

ABBY
Hey! You're going on your trip?

VICTOR
Yep.

ABBY
Sucks dick that we never really
got to know each other, you know?

VICTOR
Yeah...

There is a long moment of silent tension. Beat.

ABBY
Do you have any gum, Victor?

VICTOR
I thought you'd never ask.

Victor pulls a pack of gum out of his jeans and hands her a piece.

They chew their gum and stare at each other for a beat. They start making out for a few seconds. They stop.

VICTOR (CONT'D)
Abby, my trip doesn't come back
till tomorrow.

ABBY
Don't go.

VICTOR
I...

Abby reaches down out of frame and cups Victor's groin. Victor excitedly rises two inches into the air.

Neil leans out.

NEIL
Let's go!

VICTOR
(to Abby)
I'll be back tonight.

INT. RADIO STATION - MORNING

ARTY SOLOMON, 15, chubby and dirty, sits in a tiny closet that's been set up as a makeshift radio station. Arty wears a grubby "Weird Al" t-shirt, tight, ugly, blue gym shorts and a netted beekeeper's helmet.

ARTY
This is the Beekeeper, here on
Camp Firewood radio. And I've got
my drones working hard on a
breakfast time Rock Block...

McKinley peeks in the door, startling Arty.

MCKINLEY
Hey. I need you to take a shower.

ARTY
Okay.

MCKINLEY
Because your parents are coming
tomorrow and I don't want to get
in trouble.

ARTY
Sure.

MCKINLEY
Because you haven't showered once
yet this summer.

ARTY
Fine, no problem.

MCKINLEY
Arty, take a shower. You're
covered in dirt.

ARTY
Fine.

McKinley nods and leaves.

Arty looks around the room. He puts on the headphones and turns on the mic...

ARTY
This is Arty Solomon - alias, "The
Beekeeper"...

EXT. BETH'S OFFICE - DAY

At this point, Susie, Ben, Katie, Coop, sexy LINDSAY and others have joined JJ, Gary, and McKinley hanging out on the hill.

SUSIE
I'm really gonna miss this place.

COOP
Me too.

BEN
Hey! Let's all promise that ten years from today, we meet up again and see what kind of people we've blossomed into.

LINDSAY
Yeah...

(pause)

BEN
What time do you wanna meet?

JJ
You mean ten years from now?

BEN
Yeah.

COOP
I'd think we should get together in the morning, so we can make a day of it.

SUSIE
So, like, what is it? 9? 9:30?

COOP
Why don't we stay 9, and that way we can be here by 9:30.

MCKINLEY
Why don't we 9:30 and make it your beeswax to be here at 9:30. We'll be in our late twenties by then. We shouldn't be having problems getting places on time.

GARY
Okay, then it's settled - 9:30 it is. All agreed?

ALL
Agreed.

GARY
Great.

MCKINLEY
Because I have something at
eleven.

GARY
You've just got, like, a Trapper
Keeper full of appointments,
right?

MCKINLEY
No, I just- I have something at
eleven that I can't change again
because I already moved it twice.

EXT. SCIENCE CLEARING - DAY

Professor and his class. The professor is looking up into the
sky.

CAPED BOY
What are you looking at? Do you
see a UFO in the sky?

PROFESSOR
Oh, it's nothing. Nothing you
should worry about. Yet.

INT. MESS HALL - DAY

Andy sits alone at one of the tables. Half asleep, he
aggressively finishes off a plate of pancakes than carelessly
pushes his plate off the table -- it falls to the floor. He
wipes off his face with a napkin, gets cup and starts walking
out. Beth sees this and cuts him off.

BETH
Andy! Are you gonna clean that up?

ANDY
(Half asleep)
Uh...I will...yeah...I just don't
have time right now...

BETH
Andy, clean up your plate and come
to the hill for the meeting.

ANDY
Ugghhhhh....

Andy begrudgingly, slowly, painfully, buses his one dish. He acts like he's been in the desert without water for weeks. Beth doesn't budge. At a certain point, Andy looks up at Beth hoping she'll see how difficult this is for him and let him off the hook. She doesn't. Finally he gets the plate onto the clean-up tray and collapses dramatically. Beth rolls her eyes.

INT. ARTS AND CRAFTS BUNK - DAY

Complete silence. The campers are astonished. Finally one little boy, AARON, speaks.

AARON
Gail, are you okay?

GAIL
(through the tears)
Yeah, I'm okay. You know, it just that, uh, my husband - Ron, nohe's my ex- husband. I guess I need to get used to that. "Ex!" You know, I thought after Jonas and I separated, everything was lost...and then I met Ron and it seemed like this time it would work out...

AARON
Keep going. We're with you.

GAIL
I'm just such a total wreck, you know? I didn't even have crayons...

She bursts into tears again.

AARON
(Rubbing her shoulders)
I know, I know, I know, I know...Gail, listen to me. Ron is who he is, and you cannot change that, okay? Gail look at me. I want you to say "okay".

GAIL
(still crying)
Yeah, okay.

AARON
Okay. Good.

EXT. BETH'S OFFICE - DAY

All counselors (except Victor and Neil) are now gathered.

BETH
Okay. First I wanted to thank all of you. For helping to make this summer, without rival, the single greatest eight weeks in my entire life!

The counselors applaud. Beth refers to a clipboard.

BETH (CONT'D)
Let's get to the business. Coop, the camp goat took a shit in the infirmary. Go clean it up!

COOP
That's impossible.

NURSE
It is possible...and it happened...on my shoes.

BETH
Abby, Bunk 8 wants to watch *The China Syndrome*. You gotta run the BetaMax.

ABBY
Again?!-

BETH
I don't know what to tell you. They love it. McKinley, there're four lower campers stuck on the ropes course, I meant to tell you about that yesterday. Would you mind dealing with that?

JJ and McKinley are engrossed in a conversation not listening. (They're saying "apples and oranges, apples and oranges, apples and oranges...".)

BETH (CONT'D)
And finally, the talent show is tonight and we still have a lot of hard work to do. Which means--

The counselors groan and everyone gets up and starts chattering and walking off.

BETH (CONT'D)

This is not a joke people. I'm not joking. I'm not Ruth Buzzi. Okay? This isn't Ruth Buzzi standing here.

Everyone walks off in different directions. We stay with JJ and McKinley. They spot STEVE, the mysterious, reclusive counselor-in-training, who scribbles furiously on a pad of graph paper as he moves several homemade sundials into different positions.

JJ

Steve! Whatcha got there?

Steve looks up at JJ and McKinley like a deer caught in headlights. He speaks in a monotone robot voice:

STEVE

I have been programmed by my galactic master not tot all to Earth denizens of the classification JJ and McKinley-i-zoid.

Steve gathers his stuff off the bench and runs away.

MCKINLEY

Your brother's a freak.

JJ

I know.

EXT. BETH'S OFFICE - DAY

Beth and Katie are talking on Beth's porch.

BETH

Katie, you're considered hot, right, like, like you're hot.

KATIE

I suppose so.

BETH

So when you're wanting to look really hot, what would that be...like, what's that? Would you wear a clean pair of pants?

KATIE

Beth, don't be silly. Pants? Are you kidding?

BETH

Of course I'm kidding! Pants! Didn't you get it? As if! Pants! I would never! Pants! Katie! So what would you wear? Slacks? Pants?

KATIE

I don't know, I'd wear a sexy dress or something.

BETH

Nice. You're good. And what else?

KATIE

I'd do my hair.

BETH

Get outta town, girl.

KATIE

I will not get outta town. I'm serious. And a little mousse.

BETH

You mean like moose? A moose?

Beth makes little moose antlers with her fingers.

KATIE

No - like mousse, in your hair.

BETH

Oh right! Sure. What kind do you recommend for me? I've never used it before.

KATIE

What?

BETH

Huh? What's up?

KATIE

Wait a minute Beth...are you? You dog! You have a crush on someone!

BETH

Yeah, well, but I don't think he's interested.

KATIE
Don't be silly, Beth. Come on, I'm
gonna go mousse you up.

They go inside the office.

EXT. WATERFRONT - DAY

Andy sits out on the floating dock at the far end of the swimming area of the lake, in the lifeguard chair, tanning with JJ, while a few campers swim. He started at sexy Lindsay, as she gets out of the water in a bikini.

10-year-old ERICA yells across the swimming area to Andy.

ERICA
Andy! Can I take out the motorboat
and drive it around the lake?

ANDY
Sure.

ERICA
Wow! Thanks!

ERICA takes the keys off the rack and runs off.

ANDY
Make sure there's gas in the tank
when you're done! And be careful
with the... Whatever.

Andy spins his lifeguard whistle around as he lounges in his chair soaking in the rays.

ANDY (CONT'D)
I'd give anything for two minutes
in the closet with Lindsay.

JJ
What about Katie?

ANDY
Who?

JJ
Excellent!

They share a mini hi-five. JJ walks into the water and swims away. Andy picks up a notepad and jots something down.

Lindsay comes over and climbs up to Andy's chair.

LINDSAY
Hi. What are you writing on?

ANDY
It's my gournel. I write my
thoughts in it every day.

LINDSAY
Oh - you mean a journal?

ANDY
Yeah, whatever, I guess I'm not
all smart like you.

Lindsay smiles flirtatiously.

LINDSAY
Can I see what you're writing?

ANDY
Actually, Lindsay, only three
people are allowed to look at
this. Me, myself and I.

LINDSAY
I want you to share it with me.

Lindsay licks the inside of Andy's ear. Erica zooms by in the
ski boat.

EXT. BUNK AREA - DAY

Coop and Katie talking. Katie has a notebook.

KATIE
Let's see. Debbie Waxman?

COOP
Ahhh - she makes that weird piggy
face when she talks.

KATIE
Right. Good. No piggy face.
Rachael Schwartz?

COOP
Nah...

KATIE
She's a slut! She'll go.

COOP
I'll pass.

KATIE

Yeah - you're not the slut type.

COOP

Yes I am. I love sluts. Sluts rock. It's just got to be the right slut, you know?

KATIE

Yeah. How about Susie?

COOP

Yeah, I could go for Suisie. You know we went out my first summer here.

KATIE

When you were ten.

COOP

We were ten, yes, but we were into some heavy shit.

KATIE

What? You went all the way?

COOP

You bet we did. We went all the way, we went all the way back. We did doggie style, pony style, Style Council: good band. Also Human League has some good stuff. They're hot right now. The League of Nations, that whole thing, why stop there? The U.N., the United Nations, that brings in the whole category of countries. I mean where to start, where to start, I mean an obvious one, birthplace of spaghetti, pasta, all that oily stuff: Italy. Now you go.

KATIE

How about Italy?

COOP

Good! Safe; because I sort of paved the way with that one, but uh... (beat) What?

KATIE

What?

Beat.

NURSE (O.S.)
Hey guys.

Reveal Nurse standing there.

KATIE
Hey Nancy.

NURSE
Hi Katie.
(to Coop)
Coop. Goat shit.

Nurse gestures to the infirmary.

EXT. WATERFRONT - DAY

Andy and Lindsay are making out. A group of campers whistle them on.

10-year-old Erica drives the motorboat back, and while trying to jump onto the dock, falling into the lake. She swallows some water and starts choking a bit.

ERICA
ANDY! Help me! I fell off the boat!

ANDY
(coming up for air)
You French great.

LINDSAY
You're not so bad yerself, Mr. Man.

ERICA
Andy help me I can't swim!

ANDY
Cut it out, Erica. You're fine.

ERICA
For Christ's sake, Andy, help me!
I'm drowning!

Erica now DISAPPEARS under the lake.

EXT. SCIENCE CLEARING - DAY

Beth approaches Professor Neumann and his campers who are doing a science project. Her hair is heavily moussed. He gets up to talk to her, wiping off his hands.

PROFESSOR

Hey Beth! I like the new look!
Tres chic!

BETH

Well thank you for noticing,
Henry.

PROFESSOR

Please, call me Henry.

BETH

Okay. Then Henry it is. So I guess
you decided to come over and teach
some campers after all...Henry.

PROFESSOR

Yeah - I'm sorry about snapping at
you before. I'm just a bit shy
around children. But it's been
great. I've got them making
miniature black holes out of
paperclips and soot.

BETH

Wow! That's amazing. What you do
is so fascinating.

PROFESSOR

Do you really like astrophysics?

BETH

Are you joking? It's my biggest
hobby!

PROFESSOR

Really? Who's your favorite
astrophysicist?

BETH

You know what? Oh my god. Is it -
what time is it?

PROFESSOR

(checking the sun)
Nine, nine-thirty.

BETH

Oh my god, I'm so late for my
meeting with, uh Jim Stansel. You
know "Jim"... the uh, guy... I've
gotta go! Will you excuse me?

PROFESSOR

Okay. Well later then.

She sprints off.

EXT. WATERFRONT - DAY

Andy surveys the portion of the lake where the small boy was and just sees a few bubbles, then no bubbles.

Another small camper, FELIX swims up to Andy.

FELICIA
Andy, have you seen my swimming
"buddy"?

ANDY
Uh...

FELICIA
If I can't find her, I'm telling
Beth that you let her drown.

ANDY
I was busy!

FELICIA
It's your job to make sure kid's
don't drown.

ANDY
Lindsay, I need, like, twenty
minutes. I gotta talk to this kid.

EXT. RURAL HIGHWAY - DAY

A VAN drives down at high speed down a remote highway. In the van are Andy and Felicia, who we hear in voice-over:

FELICIA (V.O.)
Where are we going, Andy?

ANDY (V.O.)
To a big secret secret pizza
party!

FELICIA (V.O.)
Wow, cool! I love pizza.

ANDY (V.O.)
Yeah, well.

At this point, the passenger door opens and Felicia is THROWN out of the van, tumbling down the embankment.

EXT. BETH'S OFFICE - DAY

Beth runs past the office and sees the nurse.

BETH

Nancy, say I wanted to get a book,
on, like astrophysics. Where would
I find something like that?

NURSE

Off the top of my head I would say
a book store, or a library.

BETH

Alright - yeah - just curious.
Keep up the good, uh..Keep up the
good work.

Just a moment later, the Professor approaches the nurse.

PROFESSOR

Excuse me, Nancy, say I wanted to
get a book on...uh...

NURSE

What?

PROFESSOR

Mmm - I guess -
camp...directing...is that what it
would be--

NURSE

--Henry, Henry! Library.

EXT. PARKING AREA - DAY

Beth drives up the road in her pick-up truck. The Nurse runs
out.

NURSE

Beth! If you're going into town,
will you pick up something for me
at the drug store? My husband's
coming today, and I need some
lube.

BETH

What?

NURSE
 (leans in, quietly)
 For my pussy.

Beth shakes her head and makes a U-turn and drives up the road past Katie, Susie, Coop, McKinley and JJ.

JJ
 Oh cool! Beth's going to town -
 let's go!

BETH
 No! No!

They all (except Coop) pile into the truck.

MCKINLEY
 Let's go Beth, drive!

JJ
 I want ice cream!

KATIE
 Get in, Coop.

COOP
 Ehh...

ALL
 Come on!!

Coop gets in. Beth puts the truck in gear and they drive off.

EXT. WATERVILLE - VARIOUS - DAY

TRIP TO TOWN MONTAGE:

As *Love is Alright Tonight* by Rick Springfield plays-

-- The group arrives in town and gets out of the pickup.

-- In the town library, Beth peruses a large aisle marked "Astrophysics". Unbeknownst to her, Professor Neumann is on the other side of the stack of shelves, in the aisle marked "Camp Directing."

-- Katie and Coop walked by the trees in the center of town with ice cream cones.

-- McKinley, JJ and Susie gleefully revel in the rare opportunity to eat McDonald's French fries.

-- Back at the truck, Susie and Katie light cigarettes. Beth approaches upset before laughing and joining them in a smoke.

-- JJ and McKinley walk out of a deli with a couple six packs of beer. The others cheer excitedly.

-- The gang is laughing hanging out and drinking their beer in the town square. JJ pulls out a joint. They start taking hits off it.

-- While the others wait on the corner, Katie and Coop go into a back alley and score hundreds of dollars worth of cocaine.

-- JJ and Beth run up on a sweet old lady and mug her, making off with her purse.

-- A decrepit squatters apartment. In a drug haze, our counselors are strewn all over the floor. Other junkies and derelicts are there.

FADE OUT MUSIC

EXT. PARKING AREA - DAY

Beth and the others pull back into the parking lot. They look completely fresh and normal. Gary approaches.

GARY

Hey! How was Waterville?

COOP

It was fun.

JJ

It's always fun to get away from camp...even for an hour.

Katie walks off.

COOP

Katie! I'll see you later, right?

KATIE

Definitely.

Coop melts.

EXT. HIGHWAY 95 - DAY

Victor drives the van full of campers. One camper, in the back seat, farts. Everyone laughs uproariously. In the front, Victor turns to Neil, who puts on his eyeglasses and looks at a map.

VICTOR
How far away is this god damn
river?!

NEIL
At least another two hours, Vic.
Please try to forget about Abby.

VICTOR
I can't! This is my last chance!

NEIL
What are you talking about?

VICTOR
Neil, I'm gonna tell you something
but if you tell anyone, I wear to
god...

NEIL
What?

VICTOR
I'm a virgin.

NEIL
You're joking, dude, right? You're
the stallion! You've had sex with
fifty women!

VICTOR
It's actually closer to zero.

NEIL
Oh my god, you're such a loser!

Victor floors it.

EXT. BARBECUE PIT (BUNK AREA) - DAY

At the barbecue pit, Gary prepares meats for a picnic. Gene
standing behind him.

GENE
(unprompted)
What?

GARY
What?

GENE
You listen to me "Mr. Kick Ass",
"Mr. Rubber Burner"...

GENE

You wipe that hot shot grin off
yer face or I'll shoot it off of
you! You got that? Now finish up
them taters, I'm gonna go fondle
my sweaters.

GARY

What?

GENE

Finish up the taters.

GARY

And then what'd you say?

GENE

And then what did I say?!

GARY

You said you're gonna go fondle
your sweaters.

GENE

Ha. No I didn't. I said I'm
"fondue with cheddar". I was
thinking about making fondue with
cheddar cheese for dinner tonight.

GARY

No Gene, that is not what you
said.

GENE

It is what I said. Fondue with
cheddar.

GARY

Ok fine.

GENE

OK see you later.

Gene heads off, but after a few moments comes back and heads
the other way.

GENE

Just gonna stop by my bunk for a
real quick sec.

Gary picks up a can of vegetables.

GARY

(to the can)

Maybe you should talk to him.

INT. RADIO STATION - DAY

A disheveled Arty sits in his tiny cubicle.

ARTY
...so then, Rabbi Rothstein calls,
and - by the way, I know his son
Mark...

McKinley sticks his head into the room.

MCKINLEY
Did you take a shower yet?

ARTY
Yeah of course.

MCKINLEY
Did you?

ARTY
No.

MCKINLEY
Take a shower.

McKinley leaves.

ARTY
(into the mic)
Sorry folks for the "coitus
interruptus", if you will. I know
we're all hungry for the picnic,
and big camper/counselor capture-
the-flag game, so don't eat too
many barbecued bovine muscles -
read "hamburgers". Thank you.

INT. ARTS AND CRAFTS BUNK - DAY

Gail sits in a circle with her group of 9-year-old campers.
She's crying.

AARON
Gail, if I could just interject
something here.

AARON

This is gonna sound like I'm putting down my own gender, but the truth is, a lot of the time, men can be real -- and excuse the Yiddish -- insensitive schmucks. It's true.

GAIL

I know, I know, I know. It's just that - I'm 34 years old, and I don't know if I'll ever meet another...

Gail Burts into tears. The campers rush to aid her. Aaron starts giving Gail a shiatsu massage.

AARON

Shh...shh...shh...

GAIL

Your hands are magic...

EXT. MOOSE RIVER CAMPSITE - DAY

Victor pulls the van into the clearing. He jumps out and screams to his campers.

VICTOR

Everyone! Immediately get out of the van! Get out of the van!

He swings the doors open and starts ripping campers out of the back.

Neil, shaking off a nap, approaches the frenetic Victor.

NEIL

Vic, what are you doing?

VICTOR

I'm going back to camp. I'll come back and get you guys in the morning.

Victor pulls another camper out of the back and then turns to Neil.

VICTOR

What? She loves me, Neil!

NEIL

Now wait a minute! You can't just...you can't get there and back by sun up!

VICTOR

I'm gonna be with Abby Bernstein tonight. And if you don't like that, well you can go right on ahead and fuck yourself!

Victor jumps in the van and speeds off (the raft falls off the van), leaving Neil with all the young campers.

NEIL

You're making a big mistake Victor Pulak. A big mistake.

EXT. COUNTRY ROAD - DAY

Victor speeds down a curvy unpaved road in the van. Overjoyed at the thought of losing his virginity to Abby Bernstein, he sings the lyrics to "Danny's Song" by Loggins & Messina.

VICTOR

"...even though we ain't got money, I'm so in love with you honey and everything will bring a chain of loo-ooo-oove...yeah...and in the morning when I rise, bring a t--" OH FUCK!!!

Suddenly, with no warning, the van CRASHES into a tree.

VICTOR (CONT'D)

Shit!!! Abby!

INT. ABBY'S BUNK - DAY

"Danny's Song" hums out of a small tape player on Abby's bed table.

She looks sadly out her window. Lonely. Romantic. She looks up. Standing in her door is Gary.

GARY

Hey, Abby. I thought this was a different bunk.

ABBY

No...um...

GARY
Am I bothering you?

ABBY
Not at all. Come sit on my bed.

He does. He hands her a stick of gum. They chew for a bit then start making out.

EXT. COUNTRY ROAD - DAY

Victor gets out of the van and surveys the damage. The fender has lodged itself into the tire, rendering the van underivable. He opens his canteen, which is empty.

He starts walking down the barren road. No sign of humanity.

VICTOR (CONT'D)
Wait for me Abby Bernstein! Wait
for me my darling!

INT. ABBY'S BUNK - DAY

Abby and Gary going at it. Abby looks up, as if she heard something.

ABBY
Wait!

GARY
What?

Beat.

ABBY
I just wanna take off my shirt.

EXT. MOOSE RIVER - DAY

Neil and six campers in a large inflatable raft on the moose river.

CAMPER #1
Where are we going?

NEIL
I don't know. Victor took the
maps. Shut up and paddle.

CAMPER #2
I want Victor back!

NEIL
We all want him back Sammy, but
he's not coming back.

CAMPER #2
(sotto)
My name isn't Sammy.

CAMPER #1
We'll die without him, Neil. He's
the only one who can navigate the
rapids!

NEIL
Fine! You're right! I'll find the
son-of-a-gun. And I'll bring him
back here if it's the last thing
I'll do, dead or alive!

CAMPER #1
Alive. We need him alive.

Neil STOPS the raft short and spins it around like a police car
getting a call.

He speeds to the riverbank, and jumps out of the raft, leaving
the campers floating with the current.

NEIL
Wait here.

EXT. MOOSE RIVERBANK - DAY

He sees a man camping out with a tent near the river. Parked
next to his tent is a MOTORCYCLE. Neil jumps onto the
motorcycle and skids away.

EXT. MOOSE RIVER - DAY

THE CAMPERS FLOAT DOWN THE RIVER ALONE IN THEIR RAFT.

EXT. A SMALL RURAL HIGHWAY - DAY

Victor walks down the highway with his thumb in the air.
Suddenly we hear the sound of Neil's motorcycle approaching.
Victor looks back, sees Neil, and starts running.

A big RUNNER VS. MOTORCYCLE CHASE SCENE:

Neil puts on more speed; Victor runs faster. Victor suddenly
takes a right turn off a side road, Neil follows.

Victor JUMPS over a small bale of hay. Neil screeches to a halt at the small bale of hay, nearly tipping over. Victor runs free.

EXT. SWIMMING HOLE - DAY

JJ, Gary and McKinley sneak up behind other hot female counselors taking off their clothes to go skinny-dipping. They duck under the rock and whisper to each other.

JJ
Oh my god - check out Lindsay's
chicken wings!

GARY
Debbie Epstein has, like, Playboy
titties! This is just like Klute!

McKinley turns away. JJ looks again - the girls are totally undressed.

JJ
Holy shit! You guys! Look look
look!

They all look as they jump into the water.

MCKINLEY
(abruptly)
Hey, um, I'll catch you guys
later.

An awkward beat. McKinley ambles off. JJ and Gary, astonished by his departure, watch him as he goes.

GARY
Dude that's kinda sad.

JJ
He's so uncomfortable when we talk
openly about sexual issues. You
know he's never been with a girl
before.

GARY
He needs to experience the
ultimate. And I think you know
what I'm talking about.

JJ
You mean penis in vagina?

GARY
No dickhead! Sex!

They pause to watch the female counselors toss a beach ball.

JJ
I'm sure we could convince one of
the girls from bunk 10. They're
really horny this summer.

GARY
Where'd he go anyway?

EXT. FIELD HOUSE FIELD/EQUIPMENT SHACK - DAY

McKinley, solemnly, walks across the lawn.

INT. EQUIPMENT SHACK - DAY

Ben is in the shack getting lights for the talent show. A knock on the door. Ben answers it. McKinley stands in the doorway.

EXT. SWIMMING HOLE - DAY

JJ
What about Debbie? She's in heat?

GARY
Yeah, she wants to French!

JJ
No you stupid ass, she wants to
get boned! (pronounced "baoind")

GARY
Then I want her.

JJ
It's not about you, it's about
McKinley!

INT. EQUIPMENT SHACK - DAY

The lights are off. Sun seeps in through the cracks in the walls.

Ben and McKinley stand opposite each other in silence. Silhouetted in the rays of the sun coming in, they take off each other's shirts and begin gently kissing and caressing each other's bodies.

EXT. SWIMMING HOLE - DAY

JJ
Okay. Tonight. Get McKinley laid!

GARY
Come hell or high water!

JJ
Secret handshake!

JJ and Gary do their secret handshake

JJ AND GARY
Get McKinley laid!

INT. EQUIPMENT SHACK - DAY

McKinley is passionately making love to Ben from behind. They glow beautifully as their bodies mesh together.

EXT. BASEBALL FIELD - DAY

A large group of campers and counselors have assembled on the field.

Coop, with baseball cap and mitt, raises his hand to quiet everyone down.

Behind him stands JJ in a makeshift bat boy outfit.

COOP
Alright. Now as everyone knows,
today is the big culminating,
climactic softball game against
the evil Camp Tiger Claw.

As Coop speaks, we scan over the hopeful faces of the gathered campers ready for the big game.

COOP (CONT'D)
But we've put together an unlikely
team of misfits and we've been
training like crazy all summer.
Yeah, it's a motley crew that
you'd never think would be able to
win a single game. We had a kooky
training period where it seemed
like nothing was going right, but
somehow we made it to the finals.

COOP (CONT'D)

And when those anonymously evil campers from Tiger Claw get here, we'll give it our best shot and hopefully we can come from behind at the last moment, using some weird trick play, and beat our arch nemesis at their own game! Whattaya say team?

Awkward silence. One camper finally speaks up...

ALEXA

It sounds like pretty well worn territory.

TIMOTHY

The whole thing feels kinda trite. I say we forget it.

COOP

Does everyone feel that way?

ALL

Yeah.

COOP

Fine with me. I could give a shit, personally.

In the background, a huge bus drives into frame with "CAMP TIGER CLAW" painted on the side. Coop runs over to t

Coop sees the bus and jogs over. We watch in the distance as he talks to the Tiger Claw coach. We can barely make out what they are saying.

The coach eaves to the Firewood team and get back on the bus with his camper and drives away.

Coop returns.

COOP (CONT'D)

They were cool with it. It's not a big deal.

EXT. BASEBALL FIELD - DAY

JJ and Gary hiding behind a bush, looking across the field.

GARY

Look!

In the distance, they see McKinley sneaking into another part of the woods, and Susie following after him.

JJ and Gary look at each other and hi-five.

JJ
McKinley's gonna score with Susie!

GARY
He'll need some eyewitnesses for verification. Let's go!

They follow McKinley and Susie into the woods.

GARY
They must have gone to the lake...

They giggle as they run.

EXT. FOREST LAKE - DAY

JJ and Gary peak out from the woods and look over to the lake. They see Susie playing a wooden flute near the edge of the water.

JJ
Why does she still have her clothes on?

GARY
It looks like she's playing the flute.

JJ
Wow, kinky!

They look further and see that several other counselors are doing a modern dance around a misty inlet, where, standing up to their knees in the water, are Ben and McKinley. They are wearing African muslin outfits, and have flowers woven into their hair.

Beth is there, wearing a ceremonial gown. A dozen others have gathered.

BETH
As bared witness by myself, all of us here at Camp Firewood, and by the higher power, however you may define it, I hereby sanctify and consecrate the union of Ben and McKinley.

BETH
May their majestic and blessed
love flourish all the days of
their lives. Amen.

The flute music continues as Ben and McKinley kiss lightly.

ALL
Amen!

JJ and Gary watch from their hideout in total shock.

JJ
McKinley's a fag!

GARY
McKinley's a fag, with Ben!

JJ
What are we gonna do?

EXT. BUNK AREA - DAY

...Moose stands on top of a cabin with Paul and belts with vibrato:

MOOSE
CAPTURE THE FLAAAAAG!

Someone blows a whistle and the game kicks off:

The staff and campers chase and tagging each other in an effort to get each other's flag.

EXT. BUNK AREA - DAY

Steve, the mysterious loner, sits alone throwing peas at a tree and taking notes. Beth approaches Susie and Ben.

BETH
Hey - aren't you going to eat something?

STEVE
(robot voice)
I'm not hungry.

Susie and Ben wait while Beth sits down with Steve.

BETH (CONT'D)
You haven't made any friends this summer, have you?

STEVE
(robot voice)
No I have not.

BETH
Let's drop the robot voice.

STEVE
(normal voice)
Okay.

BETH
This is your first year here, huh?

STEVE
Fifth. You were my counselor last year.

BETH
OK well now I'm the camp director so whatever I can do to make your last day here better...

STEVE
You'd do that for me?

BETH
Hey, I know! Why don't you show all of us what you've been working on tonight at the talent show? It could be your act. That way people could get to know you a little better.

Beth looks up at Susie and Ben. They both shake their heads.

STEVE
Really could I? It's not a song or anything...

BETH
Of course you can. Susie and Ben will put you on the list.

Steve awkwardly lunges at Beth.

STEVE
Oh, God. Thank you.

He hugs her and gives her a kiss sort of on her nose, then runs away.

EXT. CAPTURE THE FLAG SIDELINES - DAY

Katie, Andy and some others lay on the grass watching the game. Andy lays his head on Katie's lap while she plays with his hair.

KATIE

How was the waterfront this morning?

ANDY

It was good.

KATIE

Are we gonna get a chance to spend some time together later?

ANDY

Katie are gonna pound this into my face all day?

KATIE

Sorry.

ANDY

Apology accepted.

KATIE

Guess what? A bunch of us went to town today, and we had ice cream and-

ANDY

-smells like the ribs are ready!

He hops up and heads toward the barbecue pit.

EXT. BUNK AREA - DAY

Susie and Ben approach Beth.

SUSIE

Beth, I may regret saying this... but how dare you usurp my authority as producer slash director of this talent show? I mean you are wrong to do that. I need you to know that I've been busting my balls woman. The show numbers are a mess, my performers are a bunch of amateurs.

SUSIE
The last thing I need is some
diabetic freak prancing around on
stage making my life a living
hell!

Beth stares her down. Susie capitulates.

SUSIE (CONT'D)
Alright I'll put him last.

Beth walks away.

SUSIE (CONT'D)
(shouting)
Aggh, she always wins!

EXT. SCIENCE CLEARING - DAY

The science group gathers around Professor Neumann who is
arranging different sized rocks on the ground.

PROFESSOR
You see? This is us, and we're
traveling around the sun! That's a
1.3 million mile trip every year!

CAPED BOY
Radical!

PROFESSOR
You might say that each and every
one of us are crew members here on
spaceship earth.

MORK GUY
When would we say that?

PROFESSOR
Anytime. Dinner...literally
anytime.

CURE GIRL
You're amazing. I hope that when I
grow up, I can come to your
college and you can be my
professor!

PROFESSOR
I'm actually just an Associate
Professor.

MEDIEVAL KID
What does that mean?

CURE GIRL
(to Medieval Kid)
Melvyn!

PROFESSOR
It means... it means that I'm
"less than."

He sighs. After an awkward moment, Cure Girl grabs him and hugs him tight. The others join in.

Beth approaches.

BETH
Hey - what's going on here?

The group unhuddles, all wiping their faces as if they've been crying for hours together. They're all choked up.

PROFESSOR
Hey Beth. We're just having
ourselves a little cry.

Beth takes a moment, gets emotional herself and joins the huddle.

BETH
I know what this group needs. Why
don't we all go eat some lunch and
watch the big Capture the Flag
game? What do you say?

PROFESSOR
I think we'll take a rain check
Beth. We're in the middle of some
pretty exciting stuff.

The kids nod in agreement.

BETH
I'll make you all a deal. Come
watch capture the flag with the
normal kids, and afterwards you
can take the whole rest of the day
to learn about the planets and
stars and pulsars,
heliocentricity, gravitational
collapse, even the science of
celestial mechanics as developed
in the early 19th century through
the work of Alexis Clairaut, Jean
d'Alembert and Pierre La Place.
Okay?

Professor's face lights up.

ALL

Okay!

BETH

Ready - break! We'll see you there!

The kids break out of the huddle and run toward the field.

PROFESSOR

I was really impressed with some of stuff you said back there.

BETH

Ahh - don't be silly...

PROFESSOR

No, Beth. You really don't know what you're talking about. I don't know where you find the time to learn about astrophysics, I mean with the camp payroll and insurance to deal with, and keeping parents happy, supervising a young staff, keeping everyone fed...

BETH

Wow!

PROFESSOR

It was in 1908 the the first American summer camps were founded in the Catskills...

EXT. BARBECUE PIT (BUNK AREA) - DAY

At the barbecue pit (also on the sidelines of the ongoing capture the flag game), Andy waits in line for ribs as Lindsay approaches and taps him on the shoulder.

LINDSAY

Is there any more corn?

ANDY

Sorry?

LINDSAY

More corn?

Andy turns and looks at Lindsay.

Lindsay smiles seductively at him. Unbeknownst to her, her entire face is SLATHERED in red, shiny barbecue sauce.

ANDY
Um, Lindsay, you, uh...

Andy motions to his face

LINDSAY
(flirtatiously mimicking
Andy's hand motion)
What? What are you doing with your
hands?

ANDY
On your face...you...um...

He motions again...

LINDSAY
(mimicking again)
Cat got your tongue Andy? What is
it?

Andy winces.

ANDY
You got barbecue sauce all over
your face.

LINDSAY
I know that. So?

ANDY
It's pretty foul.

LINDSAY
It's just barbecue sauce. Come on,
I wanna make out.

Andy looks across the lawn and sees Katie nearby.

ANDY
OK - but not here.

Andy and Lindsay sneak behind the mess hall.

EXT. SIDELINES (BUNK AREA) - DAY

The science kids come off the line from grill.

CURE GIRL
This isn't hot house corn.

MALLRAT GIRL
Well this hamburger isn't 100%
USDA choice and I'm not
complaining.

MEDIEVAL KID
In Medieval times the wildebeest
was considered a delicacy.

The whole group shushes him and he stops talking.

CURE GIRL
Well it's not hot-house.

Gene comes over to them.

GENE
Hey kid, shut the fuck up and eat
the corn!

EXT. BUNK AREA - CAPTURE THE FLAG - DAY

The game continues. The fastest camper, (who is clearly a professional adult Kenyan long distance runner) grabs the flag and begins running it back to the other side. Coop gives chase in a slo-mo sequence where he falls just short of the runner, but looks up to see Katie cheering him on.

Abby also cheers, then turns to make out with JJ.

EXT. WATERFRONT - DAY

Lindsay joins JJ and Andy as they take two young boys waterskiing. JJ drives as Andy coaches LARS, while FREDDY, life-preserver on, waits for his turn to ski.

ANDY
Good Lars! Keep your feet
together! Don't lean forward! You
got it! Good!

Lindsay and Andy make out, distracting Andy from watching Lars.

ANDY (CONT'D)
You taste like a burger. I don't
like you anymore.

At this point, Lars gets his hands caught in the tow rope, causing him to fall. His lungs fill with water as he is dragged at top speed behind the boat.

LINDSAY
Whatever.

Soon Lars' body stops flailing. Finally JJ stops the boat and Lars doesn't come up.

ANDY (CONT'D)
Dammit.

He looks at Freddy.

FREDDY
Is it my turn yet?

EXT. RURAL HIGHWAY - DAY

Andy's van speeds down the rural road. The door opens and Freddy is thrown out of the van, tumbling down a hill.

EXT. CAMPFIRE SITE - DAY

Coop shows Katie a clearing in the woods. He wipes the dirt off a log for her to sit on.

COOP
I come here when I want to think.

KATIE
It's beautiful - very barn-like.
(Beat) You know it's weird, Coop.
I was supposed to be in the woods
with Andy this afternoon, but-

COOP
Oh god, I'm sorry, you're right,
let's go back-

KATIE
-No, no. It's okay. I'll see him
later.

Beat.

KATIE (CONT'D)
Hold my hand, Coop.

Coop very awkwardly takes her hand. They stare at each other.

KATIE (CONT'D)
I'm cold.

COOP
I am too.

Beat.

KATIE
Do you want my sweatshirt?

COOP
Do you mind?

Katie takes off her sweatshirt and puts it around Coop's shoulders.

KATIE
Coop, now I'm colder than I was
before when I said I was cold.

COOP
Do you want my flannel?

Katie nods. Coop takes Katie's sweatshirt off, unbuttons his flannel, puts Katie's sweatshirt back on his shoulders.

Coop leans over to Katie and awkwardly wraps flannel back around her shoulders.

KATIE
(fondling his flannel)
This is great. I love this shirt.

COOP
Yeah, well, it's my favorite shirt
so you'll have to give it back.

KATIE
Now?

COOP
Yeah.

Katie takes off the shirt and wraps it around Coop. Their faces are close.

COOP (CONT'D)
What are we doing?

KATIE
Do you mean like with switching
the shirts?

COOP
No, I mean like, what are we
doing?

KATIE
I don't know...

They kiss. Slowly at first, not sure of it, then deeply and more passionate.

EXT. WOODS (LAKE AREA) - DAY

THE MYSTERIOUS COUNSELOR STEVE WALKS THROUGH THE WOODS. ATTACHED TO HIS HEAD IS A LARGE MAKESHIFT ANTENNA MADE OUT OF TIN-FOIL AND A NEW COKE CAN. HE STARES UP AT THE WIND BLOWING THROUGH THE TREES, MUMBLING TO HIMSELF.

INT. ARTS AND CRAFTS BUNK - DAY

Gail stands on one side of the room as campers watch.

AARON
Okay. I'm Ron, and I'm calling
you. Here we go. Ring Ring!

Gail pretends to answer a phone.

GAIL
Hello?

AARON
(deep voice)
Yeah, Gail? Hi, it's Ron.

GAIL
Yes, Ron. What do you want?

AARON
I think I'm ready to give our
marriage another shot, what do you
say?

GAIL
Uh...Uh...

BOY CAMPER
Be strong, Gail!

GAIL
No...no Ron. It's over. Goodbye.

She mimes hanging up the phone. The campers applaud and cheer.

INT. BETH'S OFFICE - DAY

Coop talks on the phone while Beth works at her desk.

COOP
Hey Mom, get Dad on the phone.
Just get him. Hi Dad. Okay, are
you sitting down? I've met
somebody.

COOP

She still has this other boyfriend, but...well, it's only a matter of time, I think. Her name is Katie. She's really great. What? I don't think so, but she might be, she's got a pretty big nose. Yeah. I know you guys worry that I have trouble meeting girls, but worry no more.

Beth looks over and smiles.

COOP (CONT'D)

I should go - she's probably looking for me. Okay. I'll see you tomorrow.

Coop hangs up the phone and takes to Beth.

COOP (CONT'D)

This feels so good, Beth!

BETH

Maybe you shouldn't jump the gun just yet, Coop.

COOP

Good one. Very good. A-plus for comedy, Beth. Ruth Buzzi better watch her back.

INT. REC HALL - DAY

On the other side of the room, Susie and Ben rehearse a group of campers in their song-and-dance number for the talent show.

SUSIE

Okay stop! I feel like I'm watching regional theater here. It's like I'm back at the Cleveland Playhouse. Your craft is a muscle, you need to exercise it. Take a break and think about what you've done.

Coop runs in.

COOP

Hey Susie - have you seen Katie anywhere?

SUSIE

No why?

COOP
No particular reason. If you see
her will you tell her I was
looking for her?

SUSIE
Sure.
(to performers)
Alright, again, with passion.

EXT. KATIE'S BUNK -

Coop goes into Katie's cabin.

COOP
Katie? Are you in here?

He sees Katie on the bed, in tears. Andy is there.

KATIE
Coop, I want to talk to you later.

COOP
Oh yeah, sure.

Andy flips him the bird. Coop leaves.

EXT. KATIE'S BUNK - DAY

Coop runs outside. Raises his arms in victory, all excited.

EXT. MESS HALL - DAY

ON THE HILL, Paul plays his guitar. Moose stands next to her.

MOOSE
(at the top of his lungs)
DINNER!!!!

INT. MESS HALL - DAY

Everyone's eating dinner. McKinley and Ben sit at one of the
tables.

MCKINLEY
Where're JJ and Gary?

BEN
Dunno.

MCKINLEY

I'm worried they might have found out about us.

JJ and Gary apparent at the door.

GARY

Hey! McKinley and Ben!

McKinley and Ben worriedly look to the door.

JJ

This is for you!

JJ and Gary roll a huge box from "CRATE AND BARREL", Into the hall.

JJ (CONT'D)

It's a chaise lounge. We didn't know if you guys maybe already had it. We have the receipt if you do.

MCKINLEY

No! We don't have it! Thank you!

BEN

It goes with the chenille throw cloth Beth's sister got us.

Everyone applauds as McKinley and Ben exchange hugs with Gary and JJ.

INT. KITCHEN - DAY

Gene is cleaning up after dinner prep.

GENE

Cooking slop for the grunts in 'Nam was easier than this.

Reveal Gene is addressing a TALKING CAN OF VEGETABLES whose lid moves up and down when it talks.

CAN OF VEGETABLES

We had no place being over there. It was a war that we couldn't win.

GENE

Yeah, well I'm gonna go smear some mud on my ass.

CAN OF VEGETABLES

What?!?

GENE

Huh, oh I said - "I hear my bud is in class" I gotta call my bud and see how his his, how his grades are. I gotta go. Leave me alone. Go away.

CAN OF VEGETABLES

Now hold on, Gene. I don't care what you do in your private time, but don't lie about it. You clearly said "smear mud on my ass." And I'll tell you something - you wanna smear mud on your ass? Smear mud on your ass, just be honest about it. Look Gene, I've never told anyone this before, but I can suck my own dick, and I do it, a lot. There, I said it. I was honest. And you know what? Being honest makes yo u feel better.

Gene nods his head pensively.

INT. RADIO STATION - DAY

Arty wears dark glasses and Viking hat.

ARTY

Arrright, arrright, cruising towards happy hour. Normally at this point I'd run down the list of after work parties goin' on, but summer camp isn't exactly the ideal demo for that sort of programming. Lookin' towards our evening meal - affectionately dubbed by those in the know as "dinner". Let's talk with Gary, our man in the kitchen, about what's cookin' tonight. "The Last Supper," if you'll indulge the biblical reference. I know Gary doesn't mind!

Arty waits for Gary to respond.

ARTY (CONT'D)

So end the suspense for us, Gary. What do we have on tap for dinner tonight?

Beat. Arty enthusiastically motions for Gary to talk.

GARY
Spaghetti, salad, bread.

Arty hands Gary a ten dollar bill and mouths the words, "Thank you". Gary exits.

ARTY
Nice to see you, Gary. I'd love to talk to you more but I gotta little Lovin' Spoonfull two-for cookie' on my stove. And don't forget to be at the field later to cheer on Coop and the softball team for the big game against Camp Tiger Claw. Never a dull moment here -- in the Beehive!

During this monologue we see the backside of Arty's console. There are no wires connecting it to anything.

"Summer in the City" by Lovin' Spoonfull starts and continues as we...

EXT. MESS HALL - DAY

Across the main lawn Coop sees Andy and Katie walking up from Katie's bunk towards the mess hall. She and Andy stop, talk for a beat, then Andy walks away from her into the mess hall. Katie lingers. Coop runs up to her.

COOP
Katie! I'm sorry about before. I hope that wasn't bad timing.

He tries to grab her hand. She doesn't let him.

KATIE
Coop we have to talk.

COOP
Okay.

KATIE
I...I think that what happened between us before was...was a mistake.

Beat. Coop thinks, trying desperately to keep pace.

COOP
What?

KATIE

I wasn't thinking straight. It was wrong.

Coop lets this sing in.

COOP

It wasn't wrong. Katie, I don't - why are you doing this?

KATIE

I'm really sorry Coop.

COOP

Tell me this is a joke. Please!

KATIE

I have a boyfriend, Coop. I can't...I can't do this...I'm sorry.

She walks toward the mess hall.

COOP

Wait! Katie!

He stops her by the door to the mess hall.

COOP (CONT'D)

When we first started hanging out together this morning, we were friends. But things changes. And I've fallen in love with you. And I know that if you'd just give me a chance, I could make you feel so good. I come to you not as your buddy, not as your co-counselor, but for the first time, as a Man. A man who loves a woman. And wants to hold her and provide for her, (making a joke) and yes, have sex with her, but no seriously... I love the way you laugh. I love the way your hair smells. I love it that sometimes for no reason you're late for shul. And I don't care that you're bow legged, and I don't care that you're bilingual. All I know is I would have said "no" to every girl on your list, because I've always wanted you.

KATIE

Coop, I don't know what to say.

Coop turns to leave. Katie steps forward.

KATIE (CONT'D)
Coop wait!

Coop runs down the steps.

INT. MESS HALL - DAY

Gene pokes his head out the kitchen doors.

GENE
Beth, can I make a quick
announcement before we finish?

BETH
Sure.

He swings open the doors, completely wiping out Susie who is carrying dirty dishes. The plates go flying and everyone looks up toward him, but Gene doesn't miss a beat

GENE
I want to thank all of you for a
terrific summer. Cooking for all
of you nice people has really
helped me get over the fact that I
fought in the Vietnam War. Have a
great winter, I'm going to go hump
the fridge!

BETH
What?

Beat. Gene takes a breath.

GENE
(like a military speech)
"Yes, folks. It's true.
I said "I'm going to go hump the
fridge". And what you may not
know, is that I own a bottle
of dick cream. I fondle my
sweaters, and I often like to
smear mud on my ass. Now
you're probably asking yourselves,
isn't he a weirdo? An outcast?
A loose cannon? Maybe. But I don't
think so. I wanna introduce you
guys to someone.

He picks up the can of vegetables.

GENE (CONT'D)

This is my friend. I don't know who he is, but I do know this. In a time when I was trying to hide myself, from myself, he was there to show me a new way, 'cause I couldn't hide from him. And I can be proud of who I am. I put it to you, Camp Firewood, as we spend our last dinner together: Be proud of who you are. (Holding back tears) Look at me Mom! I made it! I'm okay!

The whole mess hall cheers and applauds Gene's moving speech.

GENE (CONT'D)

And now, if you don't mind I have some unfinished business to attend to.

Gary rolls out a large refrigerator. Gene wraps himself around the fridge and thrusts his body against it. Gary, smiling at Gene, rolls him and the fridge back into the kitchen. The crowd cheers.

INT. MESS HALL - DAY

MOMENTS LATER: McKinley makes eye contact with JJ and Gary. JJ mouths silently "One, two, three, go!"

McKinley, JJ, Gary and others jumps up and SEIZE Arty, assisted from all sides.

Fighting huge resistance from Arty, they drag him out of the mess hall and over to the showers. The whole camp follows and helps.

ARTY (CONT'D)

Let me go! Let go of me! Let me go! Quit it!

INT. SHOWERS - DAY

They push Arty into the showers, turn on the water full force.

ARTY

You fucking assholes! Why are you doing this to me? I fucking hate you!

McKinley and company emerge out of the showers with their arms raised in victory as the crowd cheers them on.

EXT. PATH TO PICNIC TABLE - DAY

Beth and Professor walk along the lake, hand in hand.

BETH

I'm so happy now, Henry. I wonder
what will become of us tomorrow.

He's just looking at the sky, mumbling to himself.

BETH (CONT'D)

You seem distracted. What's the
matter?

PROFESSOR

Beth, tomorrow's the least of our
problems.

BETH

Don't tell me. You have crabs.

PROFESSOR

No! Yes! But that's not the point!

BETH

Then what is the point!?!

PROFESSOR

This is the the time or the place
to get into it. Beth, meet me at
the picnic table in ten seconds,
and I'll tell you all about it.

BETH

Okay.

Professor walks out of frame. We follow Beth to the picnic
table, three yards away. The professor is waiting for her
there, now in his lab coat, surrounded by all of his students,
as well as telescopes and other equipment.

PROFESSOR

Beth, hello. Well let's get right
to it. You may remember that ten
seconds ago, I told you to meet me
here by the picnic table, so I
could tell you what's going on.

BETH

Right.

PROFESSOR

Earlier today, I noticed what I thought was a planet or perhaps a meteor in the evening sky, But I now believe that object to be none other than a renegade piece of SkyLab, the NASA space station. And it's headed right for the camp.

BETH

Oh my god.

PROFESSOR

And not only that, there's no way of pinpointing exactly where it's going to land. It could kill us all.

BETH

Jesus!

PROFESSOR

Wait a minute...there might just be a way to build a homemade SkyLab tracking device!

BETH

Which accomplishes...

PROFESSOR

That way we could surmise the location of impact. We could prevent a catastrophe on the scale of the Hindenburg. Beth, will you help us?

BETH

Anything you need.

PROFESSOR

Let's do it!

INT. ANDY'S BUNK - DAY

Coop goes inside to find Andy lying on his bed, the walls plastered with photos of Christie Brinkley.

COOP

Andy. Can we talk for a second?

ANDY

Sure.

COOP
Well-

ANDY
-Time's up. You said a second.

COOP
Andy, lemme ask you something.

ANDY
So you wanna talk for more than a second, then.

COOP
Yeah.

ANDY
So what is it then? You think like a couple of minutes?

COOP
At most, say, three minutes.

ANDY
Fine.

COOP
Do you really love Katie?

ANDY
Not really.

COOP
'Cause I really really love her, man! And if you have an ounce of decency, you'll do the right thing and let her go.

ANDY
No way.

COOP
No way?

ANDY
Fuck no dude. She's hot. In fact, fuck off!

COOP
I will not fuck off! You're making a big mistake, buddy! That woman isn't your plaything!

ANDY
(calmly)
Coop, seriously, fuck off. I'm
sick of talking about this with
you.

COOP
Gawd!

EXT. ANDY'S BUNK - DAY

Coop, upset, kicks the door open and storms out, accidentally getting his foot stuck in a BUCKET. He flails around trying to get the bucket off his foot. He finally does, only to step on a RAKE which hits him on the head. Dizzy from the hit to the head, he steps on a BANANA PEEL, slips, and falls into a kiddie pool. To cap it off, the bucket lands on his head.

EXT. PICNIC TABLE - DAY

The science kids, professor and Beth have built a huge contraption out of popsicle sticks, a life preserver, a hula hoop, six potato chip tins, etc.

BETH
Is this device gonna save my camp,
Henry?

PROFESSOR
I don't know, but if it does,
we'll all be heroes. In fact, I
just got word that if we pull his
off, I could be up for the Hopkins
Prize for Physics.

BETH
The Hopkins! What a dream! You'll
get your tenure!

EXT. ROCK BY THE LAKE - DAY

Coop sits on a rock by the lake crying. Gene approaches him.

GENE
Be proud of who you are!

COOP
Huh? Gene?

GENE
It's not about the girl, Coop.

COOP
It's not?

GENE
It is, but if you can follow me
here, it..."isn't".

COOP
Oh so it is and it isn't.

GENE
Yes! Now you are ready to be
taught "the new way".

COOP
Will you help with this...what was
it? "A new way"?

EXT. FIELD, ETC. - MONTAGE, DUSK

Coop's TRAINING MONTAGE:

- SLO-MO Coop and Gene begin a race through a field.
- Gene tries teaching Coop a silly move in the dance shack. The can of veggies watches. Coop can't get it right.
- Gene and Coop walking and talking in the forest.
- Back in the dance shack: Gene, Coop, Can of Vegetables, and some middle aged men and women in a group therapy session, all wearing bathrobes. (Can of vegetables has a tiny bathrobe) Coop is listening and nodding.
- Gene and Coop continue their race through the field. Veggies watches.
- Gene and Coop continue their conversation in the woods. Coop is nodding. He understands!
- Coop, in the group therapy session, breaks into tears-
- Coop, in the dance shack, finally NAILS the dance move!
- Coop beats Gene in the race. Ge throws his hands in the air and hugs Gene.

EXT. CAMP FIREWOOD SIGN - NIGHT

Victor, panting, with stubble, inexplicably caked in blood and with a limp, runs up the path.

VICTOR
Abby! Abby! Oh my Abby! My dear
Abby!

EXT. BETH'S OFFICE - NIGHT

Neil rides the motorcycle up to the office. Obviously a stunt man, he gets off the motorcycle, and passes behind a tree, switching with the real Neil, who then approaches Beth, out of breath.

BETH
What's going on, Neil?

NEIL
Victor abandoned the canoe trip,
and now the kids are about to go
over Devil's Canyon Rapids!

EXT. MOOSE RIVER - NIGHT

Neil and Victor's campers are floating helplessly down the Moose River, huddled together, cold and hungry. In the foreground we see the perilous DEVIL'S CANYON RAPIDS.

CAMPERS
AHHHHHHHH!!!!!!!!!!

INT. BETH'S OFFICE - NIGHT

BETH
Well where did he go?

NEIL
He wanted to come back to camp.

BEN
So you left the campers alone on
the river?

NEIL
Only Victor knows how to navigate
those rapids. We need to find him
and get him back to that river.

The phone RINGS.

Beth picks up the phone, and without even saying hello, immediately yells...

BETH
It's him!

A previously unseen Paul jumps into action trying to trace the call on a series of phone devices.

BETH
Victor! We need to talk, bro!

PAUL
Keep him on as long as you can!

BETH
Victor? Victor? He's not there.
Damn!

PAUL
I got him!

NEIL
He's calling from inside the camp!

BETH
The only other phone is in the
infirmary! Let's GO!!!

Beth and Neil bust out.

INT. INFIRMARY - SECONDS LATER - NIGHT

The NURSE tends to a sick girl. Beth and Neil bust in. They break down the door and break everything in sight.

NURSE
Beth! What's the matter?

BETH
Where's the phone? WHERE'S THE
FUCKING PHONE!!?!?

NURSE
In the back room.

Beth and Neil go out of their way to break some more stuff and go into the back room, where they find the phone off the hook, and the window open.

BETH
Come on! We're losing time!

They charge out of the infirmary.

EXT. REC HALL - NIGHT

People are filing into the rec hall for the talent show.

Victor runs onto the scene like a madman.

VICTOR
Abby! Abby I wanna make love to
you!

He finds Abby making out with Moose.

VICTOR
Abby?? Moose?

ABBY
Hey - uh - you're gonna think I'm
so shallow, but what was your name
again?

VICTOR
Oh my god. Do you have any idea
what I've gone through to see you?

ABBY
You snooze, you lose, dude.

Beth and Neil arrive and seize Victor.

BETH
Victor Pulak - those kids are
about to go over Devil's Canyon
Rapids.

EXT. MOOSE RIVER - NIGHT

The kids are inches away from going over the rapids.

CAMPERS
AHHHH!

EXT. REC HALL - NIGHT

A confused Victor looks over at Abby, then at Beth, then at
Neil.

A silent moment, then...

VICTOR
Let's go!

Music kicks in as Neil and Victor run off. Beth waves, smiling
proudly.

EXT. CAMP FIREWOOD SIGN - NIGHT

Victor and Neil running full speed down the unpaved camp road.

EXT. PICNIC TABLE - NIGHT

Beth joins the Professor and his class as they put the final touches on their Skylab tracking device.

PROFESSOR

Here we go.

He turns it on. It sputters and pops. A little paper printout comes out of the bottom.

PROFESSOR

Oh, fuck my cock!

MEDIEVAL KID

What does it say?

PROFESSOR

According to the readout, Skylab is going to land right on the Rec Hall!

BETH

Oh no. When?

PROFESSOR

(reading more)

Sometime in the next 90 minutes!

CURE GIRL

Oh my god! That's only one mix tape!

MALLRAT GIRL

The talent show's starting right now!!

PROFESSOR

Beth, we need to evacuate the rec hall immediately!

EXT. MOOSE RIVER - NIGHT

The raft full of campers is still inches from going over the treacherous waterfall.

CAMPERS

Ahhhhhh!!!!

Victor and Neil arrive on the riverbank.

VICTOR
Stand back.

Victor runs toward the river and pulls out his buck-knife. We stay on Neil as he watches and cheers Victor on.

NEIL
Wow - you're a master! You're
actually doing it! You - you just
saved them!

We see none of what he's seeing.

Cut to Victor and the children triumphantly walking on the shore. Neil walks up to Victor and shakes his hand,

NEIL (CONT'D)
Victor Pulak, you're okay. You're
okay by me. (Beat) I'm okay.
You're okay.

VICTOR
And Neil, next time we go on a
camping trip, you drive the van!

They both laugh heartily and walk off arm in arm.

EXT. PICNIC TABLE - NIGHT

Professor and the class lay on the ground looking up at the sky.

CURE GIRL
I wish there was another way.

MEDIEVAL KID
Maybe we should just let them die.

MORK GUY
No. My friend Jimmy's in there.

CURE GIRL
You have a friend?

MORK GUY
I'm kidding.

CAPED BOY
What if we try to redirect the
trajectory of the object?

MALLRAT GIRL
That would be impossible.

Professor sits up and does some calculations in the air, then sits back down.

PROFESSOR
Well there is... Nah.

MORK GUY
What?

PROFESSOR
There might be a way we could use our device to slightly change its direction. But, no. There's no way.

CAPED BOY
Why? What's the problem?

PROFESSOR
Well...we'd have to somehow repeatedly generate random numbers between 1 and 20 in order to calibrate the differential.

CURE GIRL
That would take some sort of mainframe computer, and we for sure don't have one of those.

PROFESSOR
Then all is lost.

CAPED BOY
No it's not.

CAPED BOY (CONT'D)
(now standing)
Any Dungeon Master worth his weight in geldings goes nowhere without his TWENTY SIDED DIE.

A huge symphonic CRESCENDO as they all slowly sit up and smile.

INT. REC HALL - NIGHT

All the campers and counselors are gathered for the big TALENT SHOW.

Ben and Susie, on the steps, raise their hands to quiet everyone down.

BEN

Good evening Camp Firewood!
I'd like to introduce your emcee
for the evening. We brought him
all the way from Kutscher's
Country Club in the Catskill
Mountains --

BETH (O.S.)

Wait!

Beth busts in the door. Audience quiets down.

BETH

And my bad news is--

At this moment, Medieval Guy and Cure Girl bust into the rec
hall, TACKLE Beth to the ground, and whisper in her ear.

BETH

...and my bad news is, there is no
bad news. I was joking!

ALL

Beth! Good one! You rule!

BEN

Let's give a Firewood welcome to
ALAN SHEMPER!

The audience breaks into hysterical Muppet-like screaming,
whooping and clapping.

ALAN SHEMPER, over 60, dressed in a powder yellow tuxedo takes
the stage.

SHEMPER

Hello, hello! Well, well, it's
good t'be herein Camp Firewood.
You know, when I went to sleep
away camp -- in the STONE AGE --
but seriously it wasn't the Stone
Age -- it was the ICE AGE -- No
really, it was the Stone Age.

EXT. PATH TO PICNIC TABLE - NIGHT

Beth, Medieval Guy and Cure Girl running back to the group.

SHEMPER (V.O.)
 Actually, I went to Camp
 Maschnudin in the Pine Hills of
 Westchester County, New York. It
 was very old fashioned - Camp
 Machnudin...

INT. REC HALL - NIGHT

SHEMPER (CONT'D)
 ...so old we had to eat scrambled
 Teradactyl eggs!

In the audience, Gail is laughing so hard that she's moved to tears.

SHEMPER (CONT'D)
 But actually, Camp MASCH-NOODLE as
 we liked to call it, was very fun,
 very fun. Although back then, we
 didn't have cots - we had SLABS...

EXT. PICNIC TABLE - NIGHT

Beth, Medieval Guy and Cure Girl join the others who are frantically packing up the device to carry it up to the rec hall.

SHEMPER (V.O.)
 ...and instead of sleeping bags we
 had -- SLEEPING PELTS -- 'cause it
 was so long ago.

INT. REC HALL - NIGHT

SHEMPER (CONT'D)
 Our first act is a young man from
 Bunk 2 who calls himself, Roger,
 The Master Broom Balancer!

Out comes ROGER who performs the unimpressive feat of balancing a broomstick on his hand.

EXT. BEHIND THE REC HALL - NIGHT

The group is setting up the device in a clearing directly behind the rec hall.

BETH
 Okay. Let's pray to God this
 works.

They chat in Hebrew for a second: "Baruch, aaah, adonoi..."

INT. REC HALL - NIGHT

Three young girls, sit back to back on the stage, singing.

THREE GIRLS
Winter, Spring, Summer or Fall.
All you've got to do is call. And
I'll be there, yes I will, 'cause
you've got a friend.
 (speaking)
 That's from us to bunk 7!

EXT. BEHIND THE REC HALL - NIGHT

Beth, Profesor and class are gathered around their device.
 Caped Boy rolls the 20-sided die.

CAPED BOY
 18!

Professor fiddles with the machine.

PROFESSOR
 Okay, we're getting closer. Gimme
 another.

INT. REC HALL - NIGHT

On stage, a fat Jewish kid, MARTY is doing an imitation of a
 black comedian.

MARTY
 White folks sound so stupid when
 they get mad. They be like, "Hey
 asshole! I'm going to kick your
 behind!" But the brothers don't
 even have to raise their voice.
 There motherfuckers be like,
 "Don't make me say it twice."

The crowd eats it up. Moments later, Shemper on stage:

SHEMPER (CONT'D)
 Be that as it may, this next act
 is a young man named Bert
 Flugelman, it says here that you
 all know him as...

ALL
 Moooooooooooooose!

Moose comes out, lies down on the stage and lifts his legs over his head. He holds a lighters to his ass and cuts a huge fart, which creates a giant flash of fire, like a blowtorch. The crowd cheers. He stands up and raises his arms in celebration.

IN THE AUDIENCE, Gail and Aaron are doubled over in laughter.

GAIL
 That's swwooo funny!

RON (O.S.)
 Gail.

Out of nowhere, reveal Gail's estranged husband RON, 40's, with a mustache, tweed coat, and wide wale corduroys.

GAIL
 Ron...what are you doing here?

RON
 Gail, I've been thinking about you
 a lot. I want you back.

Gail looks over at Aaron and her entire group of supporting campers.

GAIL
 (Takes a deep breath)
 Ronald I love you and I want to be
 with you...(beat)...but...

The campers tense in excitement.

GAIL (CONT'D)
 I've had too many woulda-coulda-
 shoulda's in my life and I'm just
 sick and tired of being sick and
 tired. So if you can't deal with
 that then to hell with you!

RON
 You'll come back to me Gail. I
 know you will.

Gail looks over to Aaron, who nods in encouragement.

GAIL
 (Defiantly)
 I don't think so Ronald Von
 Kleinenshtein! I really don't
 think so!

Ron disappears. Her campers applaud. Gail and Aaron embrace.

BACK ON STAGE, Alan Shemper:

SHEMPER
 And now, performing, "Day By Day"
 from the musical Godspell, here's
 Susie's drama group!

Susie comes out.

SUSIE
 Before we start, I just wanted to
 say, these campers you're about to
 see suck dick! Nevertheless,
 please welcome them.

Susie walks off as as several young campers (led by Hopeful
 Little Kid in the "Annie" sweatshirt) begin a performance of
 "Day by Day" that is spectacularly outstanding by even Broadway
 standards.

The drama group nails the end of their number, with the crowd
 clapping along to the tune.

As soon as the song ends, the whole crowd collectively BOOS and
 hisses them off the stage.

EXT. PICNIC TABLE - NIGHT

Caped Boy rolls the die.

CAPED BOY
 5!

CURE GIRL
 There's not much time left!

INT. REC HALL - NIGHT

SHEMPER
 You know, my favorite part of camp
 was arts and crafts or as we used
 to call it - ARTS AND FARTS AND
 CRAFTS! But for real, I loved arts
 arts and crafts. We would make
 drawings -- CAVE DRAWINGS.

The whole audience is absolutely losing it, in hysterics.

SHEMPER (CONT'D)

One summer there were two
epidemics -- head lice and THE
PLAGUE! THE BUBONIC PLAGUE.

CUT TO:

The back door of the rec hall opens revealing the new Coop: He is now wearing a half-shirt, tiny nylon shorts, tube socks pulled up to his knees, and curiously permed hair. Everybody notices him.

Coop finds Katie leaning against the opposite wall with Andy.

COOP

Katie, I came her to tell you I'm
leaving.

KATIE

What?

COOP

I've grown up a lot since before
dinner when we last talked.

KATIE

Where are you going to go?

COOP

I don't know. See the world,
maybe. I've got two weeks before
school starts.

KATIE

But-

COOP

I want you to have this.

Coop gives her a small wrapped present - the size of a jewelry box. He nods at her, then leaves.

EXT. BEHIND THE REC HALL - NIGHT

Still rolling the dice. Beth looks up to the sky.

BETH

Hurry up, you guys. I think I can
see it coming towards us.

INT. REC HALL - NIGHT

ON STAGE, Shemper:

SHEMPER

And finally tonight, ladies and
germs, as junior counselor who
goes by the name, "Steve." Give
him a hand!

No applause - just coughing and murmur from the audience.

Steve comes out on stage, dressed in black. He raises his hands
in the air, waiting for everyone to quiet down.

GARY

Come on, do something!

JJ

Or get the fuck off the stage!

Beth rushes in to watch Steve's act. They make eye contact.

Steve raises his hands higher in the air. He then THRUSTS his
hands forward. At that moment a small BREEZE wafts through the
rec hall.

ON KATIE: Katie opens Coop's gift. From inside the small box
Katie pulls out Coop's FLANNEL SHIRT. Her eyes well up with
tears.

KATIE

(under her breath)

Oh my God...

She brushes past Andy as she races for the door.

EXT. REC HALL - NIGHT

The building shakes at its foundations. Coop walks quickly away
from the rec hall with determination in his eyes. In the
background we see Katie run out of the rec hall towards him.

KATIE

COOP! COOP!

Coop can't hear her. He keeps walking. Katie is sprinting to
catch up with him.

KATIE (CONT'D)

(crying)

Coop! Coop, don't leave! Don't
leave!

Coop keeps walking. He is at peace with his thoughts.

KATIE (CONT'D)
Coop! Oh Coop! I love you!

Coop stops and turns around just as Katie catches up to him.

KATIE
I didn't know it for sure until
this second. But now I know it
like nothing I've ever known
before and it feels so good. I
love you, Coop! I love you!

INT. REC HALL - NIGHT

ON STEVE: Steve's eyes are closed as he keeps his hands thrust forward. The breeze steadily gathers strength, and starts building to a fierce WIND blowing seemingly from Steve's fingers.

The wind gets so strong that it presses up against the faces of all in the audience, blowing their hair back. Everything that's not bolted down flies to the back of the room. Benches are tipped over.

Abby and Lindsay start making out.

EXT. REC HALL - NIGHT

COOP
How do I know this is real?

KATIE
Because, I'm telling you and
that's the best I can do! I love
you Coop!

COOP
Say it again!

KATIE
I love you! I love you Gerald
Cooperberg!

The door of the rec hall flies off the hinges, just as...

Katie and Coop KISS!

EXT. BEHIND THE REC HALL - NIGHT

Professor turns one more screw and the machine starts to vibrate.

PROFESSOR
It's working!

They all look up to the sky. The object, now getting closer, is hit by a HUGE GUST OF WIND and seems to change direction. They watch it come down, down, until - CRASH! Onto the ground safely away from the rec hall, falls a 40 foot long flaming piece of metal with an American flag and the words "Skylab" painted on it.

Beth runs over.

BETH
Way to go guys!

Beth and Professor hug. She pats some blood off his face with a wet towel.

PROFESSOR
We did it!

INT. REC HALL - NIGHT

Finally Steve lowers his hands and the wind instantaneously STOPS.

Silence for a long moment.

JJ puts two hands together and slowly starts to clap. She is joined quickly by the rest of the camp. The clapping escalates into a massive standing ovation. Everyone stands on the benches, cheering, screaming, yelling, wetting their pants, like a Beatles concert. Andy tries to put his arm around Lindsey, but she pushes him away. Steve bows graciously.

EXT. REC HALL - NIGHT

The whole camp population exits the rec hall, walking back to the bunks, many couples arm in arm. Focus on Coop and Katie in full embrace.

DISSOLVE TO:

EXT. PARKING AREA - MORNING

Parents are arriving. Campers are saying their goodbyes, loading the last of their bags onto the bus, taking pictures.

Beth stands by the entrance to the camp with some of the other staff. Professor comes up to her.

PROFESSOR

Beth! I got it! The Hopkins Award!
And NASA's hiring me to go work
for them at Cape Canaveral. I'll
have a whole new life!

BETH

That's great. I guess this means I
won't see you again. I knew this
would happen. I knew I'd meet you
and fall in love and you'd dumb
me...

PROFESSOR

Wait, hold on Beth. I've already
told them that I need an apartment
for two people. And they'll fly
you back here every summer!

BETH

(thrilled and happy)
Fuck you!!!

PROFESSOR

And I know we've had trouble with,
you know, but I was thinking when
the time comes we can adopt...

BETH

Shhh. It happened. I'm pregnant.
We're going to have a baby.

They smile and hug. Gail and Aaron walk past them arm in arm.

GAIL

Goodbye, Beth.

Gail and Aaron smile at each other and kiss.

BETH

It looks like everything worked
out for you two.

AARON

Best thing's ever happened in my
life.

GAIL

I hope you like shrimp cocktail,
because we want you to be the
guest of honor at our wedding
next week.

BETH

I'd be delighted. I just hope it's
not jumbo shrimp - because I'm
allergic to oxymorons!

HUGE laughter from all.

EXT. PARKING AREA - MORNING

Coop and Gene catch each other's eye. Coop hugs him.

NEARBY, Carol drives up in her car. Gene puts his bag in the trunk and just before he gets in, turns back and makes eye contact with the Can of Vegetables. He mouths "thank you". The Can of Veggies moves a bit in acknowledgement.

ELSEWHERE: Steve and Abby are making out.

EXT. REC HALL - MORNING

The professor joins his class as they lie down on the grass where Skylab fell.

CURE GIRL

We saved everyone's life and
they'll never know it.

MALLRAT GIRL

I almost like it better that way.

CAPED BOY

It was us rolling the dice that
diverted it, right? Not that
enormous gust of wind, right?

PROFESSOR

Right.

MEDIEVAL KID

I feel like this entire summer,
which kind of sucked, has been
revitalized by the experience of
the last 24 hours.

MALLRAT GIRL

(sigh)

Yeah...it's like...well, forget it.

MEDIEVAL KID

You know what?

CAPED BOY

What?

MEDIEVAL KID

You guys are my best friends. In fact you're my only friends.

CAPED BOY

Yeah.

MORK GUY

Nanoo-nanoo.

EXT. BUNK AREA - MORNING

Katie comes out from the bunk area dragging her duffel bag.

Coop (now looking normal again) runs up to her.

COOP

Well this is it, babe!

KATIE

Yep...

COOP

So, obviously I think we should try to meet in the city next weekend. I'll bring my parents and you can talk to your Dad and Kim.

KATIE

Listen, Coop. Last night was fun. And you were incredible heroic and romantic. No doubt about it. And that's great. But I've thought about it and my thing is this: Andy is really hot. Don't get me wrong - you're cute too, but Andy's just like, cut out of marble. He's gorgeous. He's got an incredible body and a beautiful face...

KATIE

He's so hot that I genuinely don't care that he's kind of lame -- I don't even care that he cheats on me you know? I do like you more than Andy, Coop, but I'm sixteen. When I'm ready to get married, it may be a different story, but right now I'm so entirely about sex, and I just want Andy. I wanna grab his body and take him in. I wanna fuck his brains out, you know? So that's where my priorities are right now. Sex. Specifically with Andy. And not with you. But you are really nice. Everyone thinks so. I'm sorry if that's not the direction you saw things going with us. But I totally want to be friends. You better write me another letter, okay? Cool.

A station wagon pulls up with Andy and his family.

ANDY

Katie, let's go!

Katie gets in the car and it drives off. Coop stands alone watching.

The camera cranes up to show the whole camp, cars and buses pulling away, Coop standing alone, the last one left.

BETH

How ya doin?

COOP

Good.

Beth comes over to Coop and puts her arm around him. He smiles at her and they walk off.

FADE TO BLACK

CREDITS ROLL...until...

CUT TO:

INT. BETH'S OFFICE - NIGHT

TITLE: "Ten Years Later - 9:30 AM"

In the lounge, all the characters have gathered. It is 1991. They're all much older now (27) -- they have gray hair and beards and pot bellies. Beth and Professor are there with a ten-year-old girl.

A white sheet is set-up against the wall and Gary is fiddling with a giant VCR projector. JJ runs in.

JJ

Sorry I'm late. I thought we said
9:30.

SUSIE

No. We said 9. So we could start
at 9:30.